INCH-POUND
A-A-59766A
October 14, 2022
SUPERSEDING
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February 3, 2005

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

LIFE PRESERVER, INHERENTLY BUOYANT WITH COLLAR

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description by all federal agencies.

1. SCOPE. This commercial item description (CID) covers requirements for an inherently buoyant life preserver with collar for use on U.S. Navy surface ships and submarines by personnel performing any shipboard work except flight deck operations.

2. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

2.1 Performance characteristics. The inherently buoyant life preserver with collar shall meet and pass type I personal flotation device (PFD) requirements in accordance with 46 CFR § 160.055. The vest shall provide a minimum of 22 pounds of buoyancy, be capable of turning an unconscious person that is face down in the water to an upright and slightly backward position and provide an adequate freeboard position to the wearer in offshore waters.

2.2 Design and construction. The inherently buoyant life preserver with collar shall be a PFD constructed in a vest style design and have a collar to provide head support. The vest shall contain Safety of Life at Sea (SOLAS) grade reflective tape and have pockets to contain accessories as described in 2.2.5. The back of the vest shall contain a 1-inch high by 3½-inch (-0/+½ inch) wide opening horizontally centered around the back centerline of the vest and located vertically between the wearer's shoulder blades to allow a safety harness D-ring to fit through the preserver. The vest shall contain a body adjustment strap and a chest strap. The vest design shall provide channels for routing the man overboard indicator (MOBI) antenna from its pocket to the top of the collar without affecting the transmission signal (see figures 1, 2, and 3). Unless otherwise specified herein, all measurement tolerances shall be ±¼ inch.

2.2.1 Outer shell material. The vest shell shall be the color orange and fabricated from a material conforming to the requirements of 46 CFR § 160.055.

2.2.2 Buoyant foam. The foam shall be in accordance with 46 CFR § 160.055.

2.2.3 Securing straps. The body strap shall be minimum 1-inch wide nylon, polyester, or polypropylene webbing secured with a D-ring, O-ring, slide adjuster, and snap hook ends. The chest strap shall be minimum 1-inch nylon, polyester, or polypropylene webbing secured by a metal or plastic slide buckle.

2.2.4 Sizing. The vest shall be a universal size (chest size 30 to 52 inches).

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, and any other data that may improve this document should be sent to: Commander, Naval Sea Systems Command, ATTN: SEA 05S, 1333 Isaac Hull Avenue, SE, Stop 5160, Washington Navy Yard, DC 20376-5160 or emailed to CommandStandards@navy.mil, with the subject line "Document Comment". Since contact information can change, you may want to verify the currency of this address information using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

FSC 4220

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2.2.5 Accessories pockets. There shall be two pockets sized to hold the following:

a. Distress marker light (see 6.3)
b. Flat whistle (see 6.3)
c. Sea dye marker (see 6.3)
d. MOBI (see 6.5)

2.2.5.1 Left front pocket. The left front pocket shall be located on the left front of the vest and be divided into two sections, which shall contain a whistle and a distress marker light. Each section of the pocket shall have an eyelet near the top of the pocket to attach an accessory cord for each device.

2.2.5.2 Right front pocket. The right front pocket (with a divider) shall be located on the right side of the vest and contain the sea dye marker and the MOBI (see 6.5). This pocket shall have an eyelet near the top for the sea dye marker. It shall also have a hole in the top of it to allow the passage of the MOBI antennae and another in the side to allow the MOBI to be turned on or off. The pockets shall have flaps secured by hook-and-loop tape.

2.2.6 Accessories securing cords. The distress marker light, sea dye marker, and flat whistle shall be secured to the accessories pocket with a nominal 1/16-inch diameter nylon, polyester, or polypropylene cord, having a minimum tensile strength of 90 pounds. The cord shall be 24 inches in length for the flat whistle and 48 inches in length for the distress marker light and sea dye marker. Cord length tolerances shall be ±2 inches.

2.2.7 Distress marker light patch. The left collar shall contain a 2- by 4-inch loop tape patch to temporarily attach the distress marker light in man overboard situations. The distress marker light shall have a ¾- by 1¾-inch nylon hook tape patch adhered to the back of the light.

2.2.8 Labeling. In addition to the labels and markings required by the Code of Federal Regulations, there shall be a label marked inside the preserver with the manufacturer name, vest model number, National Stock Number (NSN), and lot number.

2.3 Environmental requirements. All components shall be Underwriters Laboratories (UL) recognized for use in PFDs and shall meet the requirements for accelerated weathering in accordance with UL 1191.

3. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS. Recycled, recovered, environmentally preferable, or biobased materials should be used to the maximum extent possible, provided that the material meets or exceeds the operational and maintenance requirements, and promotes economically advantageous life cycle costs.

4. PRODUCT CONFORMANCE PROVISIONS. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5. PACKAGING. Preservation, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

6. NOTES.

6.1 Source of documents.

6.1.1 ASTM Standards. ASTM standards are available from www.astm.org or ASTM International, 100 Barr Harbor Dr., P.O. Box C700, West Conshohocken, PA 19428-2959.

6.1.2 Code of Federal Regulations (CFR). The CFR is available from www.ecfr.gov or the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Publishing Office, Washington, DC 20401.

6.1.3 UL Standards. UL standards are available from www.ul.com or COMM 2000, 151 Eastern Avenue, Bensenville, IL 60106.

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6.2 Ordering data. The contract or order should specify the following:

a. CID document number and revision.

b. NSNs.

c. Product conformance provisions.

d. Quantity required.

e. Packaging requirements.

6.3 National stock numbers (NSN). The following is a list of NSNs assigned that correspond to this CID. The list may not be indicative of all possible NSNs associated with the CID.

NSN	Item
4220-01-485-1138	Life Preserver, Inherently Buoyant, Vest
6230-01-686-4184	Distress Marker Light
4220-01-487-2931	Flat Whistle
6850-00-270-9986	Sea Dye Marker

6.4 Key words.

Personal Flotation Device

6.5 Man overboard indicator (MOBI). MOBI is not included and is purchased separately.

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FIGURE 1. Front view of the inherently buoyant life preserver.



FIGURE 2. Back view of the inherently buoyant life preserver.

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FIGURE 3. View of the inherently buoyant life preserver accessories.

CONCLUDING MATERIAL

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:
Navy – SH
Air Force – 03

Preparing Activity:
Navy – SH
(Project 4220-2022-001)

Review Activities:
Navy – AS
Air Force – 11, 184

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